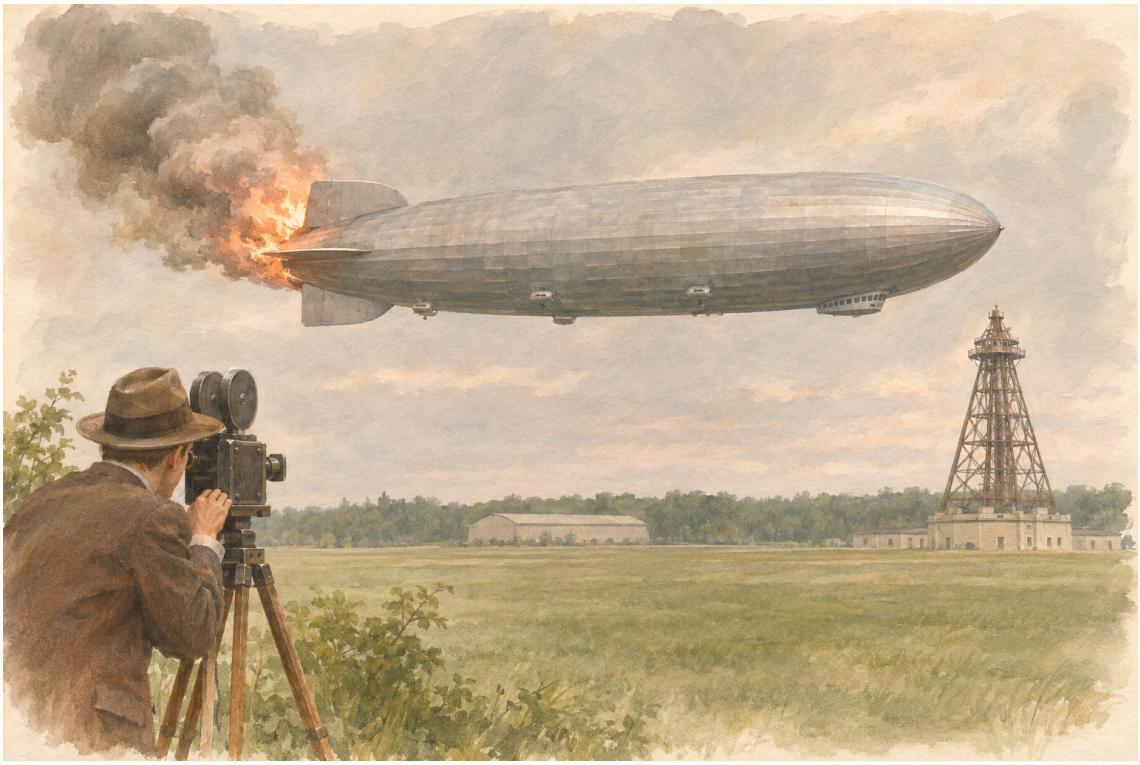
兴登堡号的 34 秒

The Last Flight of the Hindenburg



一场被拍下的大火，怎样终结了飞艇客运时代？

READ 纯净阅读 | CHECK 中文核对 | LEARN 词汇记忆 | RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In 1936 the colossal Hindenburg made 17 Atlantic round trips, a marvel of luxury and glamour. Its amenities included a lounge and, that year, a grand piano. An American embargo on helium export had left the ship relying on hydrogen. Because that gas was combustible, smokers sat behind an airlock with one electric lighter.

The airship left Frankfurt on 3 May 1937. Hours behind its timetable, it met thunderstorms at Lakehurst and circled for over an hour before its descent towards the mooring mast. At about 7:25 pm on 6 May, flames appeared near the stern. The inferno incinerated the ship in about half a minute, leaving a crumpled frame.

Of the 97 aboard, 62 survived, a proportion close to two-thirds, while a minority of 35 died, as did one man on the ground. A 14-year-old cabin boy was drenched by a deluge from a burst water tank, and the soaking saved him. He dropped through a hatch and scrambled clear, escaping only narrowly.

Newsreel cameras and photographers caught the disaster. A radio correspondent's eyewitness commentary was not live; audiences heard it the next day. The cause has not been definitively established, but static electricity igniting leaking hydrogen is the leading explanation. A theory blaming the doped fabric has been rejected.

The 1933 crash of USS Akron killed 73 yet won less notoriety. The filmed fire left a fateful image that abruptly wrecked confidence. As public perception soured, Graf Zeppelin was withdrawn, later scrapped, and a glamorous epoch of aviation closed. The doomed airship's first journey to North America had begun on 6 May 1936, exactly a year before the fire.

中文译文

1936年，庞大的兴登堡号完成17次跨大西洋往返，堪称奢华而迷人的奇观。艇内设有休息厅，那一年还配过一架三角钢琴。由于美国禁止出口氦气，飞艇只能依靠氢气升空。氢气易燃，吸烟者只能待在气闸隔开的区域，共用一个电点烟器。

1937年5月3日，飞艇离开法兰克福。它抵达莱克赫斯特时已晚点数小时，又遇上雷暴，盘旋一个多小时后才开始向系留塔下降。5月6日晚约7点25分，尾部附近出现火焰。大火在约半分钟内焚毁飞艇，只留下一副扭曲的骨架。

艇上97人中，62人生还，接近三分之二；35人遇难，地面另有一名男子死亡。一名14岁的艇上服务生被破裂水箱涌出的水浇透，这一身湿水救了他。他从舱口落下，连滚带爬逃到安全处，险些未能脱身。

新闻纪录片摄像机和摄影师拍下了灾难。电台记者的现场目击解说并非直播，听众到第二天才听到。起火原因至今没有定论，主要解释是静电点燃泄漏的氢气。把起火归咎于蒙皮织物涂层的说法已被否定。

1933年阿克伦号失事造成73人死亡，却没有那么广为人知。被拍下的大火留下了一幅影响深远的画面，骤然摧毁公众信心。随着公众看法恶化，格拉夫·齐柏林号退出运营，后来被拆解，航空史上一个充满魅力的时代就此落幕。兴登堡号首次飞往北美的航程始于1936年5月6日，恰好是失火前整整一年。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

colossal adj.
庞大的
the colossal Hindenburg

amenity n.
便利舒适设施
Its amenities included a lounge

embargo n.
禁运
An American embargo on helium export

combustible adj.
易燃的
that gas was combustible

descent n.
下降
its descent towards the mooring mast

mooring mast 名词短语
飞艇系留塔
towards the mooring mast

stern n.
飞艇尾部
near the stern

inferno n.
猛烈的大火
The inferno incinerated the ship

incinerate v.
焚毁
The inferno incinerated the ship

crumple v.
压皱；扭曲变形
leaving a crumpled frame

proportion n.
比例
a proportion close to two-thirds

drench v.
浇透；使湿透
was drenched by a deluge

deluge n.
大量涌出的水
a deluge from a burst water tank

hatch n.
舱口
He dropped through a hatch

correspondent n.
新闻记者
A radio correspondent's

eyewitness adj.
亲眼目击的
eyewitness commentary was not live

commentary n.
现场解说
eyewitness commentary was not live

definitively adv.
确切地；有定论地
has not been definitively established

static electricity 名词短语
静电
static electricity igniting

leading explanation 名词短语
主要解释
is the leading explanation

perception n.
看法；观感
As public perception soured

epoch n.
时代
a glamorous epoch of aviation

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共44项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

round trip 名词短语
往返航程

marvel n.
令人惊叹的事物

luxury n.
奢华

glamour n.
魅力

lounge n.
休息厅

helium n.
氦气

export n.
出口

hydrogen n.
氢气

smoker n.
吸烟者

sit behind 动词短语
坐在……隔开的后方

electric lighter 名词短语
电点烟器

airship n.
飞艇

timetable n.
时刻表

thunderstorm n.
雷暴

circle v.
盘旋

before prep.
在……之前

flame n.
火焰

frame n.
骨架；框架

two-thirds 数词
三分之二

a minority of 名词短语
少于半数的

cabin boy 名词短语
艇上少年服务生

burst v.
爆裂

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共44项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

soaking n.
全身湿透

scramble v.
急忙攀爬；连滚带爬

narrowly adv.
勉强；险些未能

photographer n.
摄影师

audience n.
听众

ignite v.
点燃

leak v.
泄漏

theory n.
解释；假说

doped adj.
涂有涂料的

fabric n.
蒙皮织物

reject v.
否定；不接受

notoriety n.
因坏事而广为人知

fateful adj.
影响深远而不幸的

image n.
画面

abruptly adv.
突然地

confidence n.
信心

sour v.
变坏；恶化

withdraw v.
撤出运营

scrap v.
报废拆解

glamorous adj.
富有魅力的

aviation n.
航空

doomed adj.
注定毁灭的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 An American _____ on helium export had left the ship relying on hydrogen.

02 Because that gas was _____,

03 The cause has not been _____ established,

04 As public _____ soured,

文章主线

- 隐患 兴登堡号是豪华跨洋飞艇；美国禁运氦气，使它只能靠易燃氢气浮空，留下安全隐患。
- 失事 1937年5月6日，它在美国准备停靠系留塔时尾部起火，约半分钟就烧成扭曲骨架。
- 伤亡 艇上97人中62人生还、35人遇难；地面另有1人死亡，遇难者合计36人。
- 原因 火因尚无定论，主要解释是静电点燃泄漏氢气；归咎外层布料涂层的说法被否定。
- 落幕 1933年另一飞艇事故死73人，却不及兴登堡号出名；这次影像和次日播出的录音重创信心，飞艇客运时代落幕。

参考答案　1 embargo 2 combustible 3 definitively 4 perception